

Rebuild Tigray

The motivation behind this site is not to do the work, but to get the work being done by those in diaspora highlighted.

What the site should be initially is a manifesto.

My unbridled thoughts on what is happening in Tigray raw and real.

However I need a strategy to roll it out.

How am I going to highlight the work being done?

Am I simply a news aggregator? Am I the conduit of the culture? I need to refine what my goals are.

Below is a blank space of my raw and real thoughts in a very scattered, inspired fashion as to not lose them for the sake of trying to have more clarity:

- The diaspora is disconnected for many reasons:
 - There are divisions between those with money and those that don't have it
 - There are divisions between those in power and those who don't have it or those who want it
 - There are divisions between the old who cling to outdated parts of the culture and the youth who want to make things better
- The state of Tigray itself is disconnected
 - We can't seem to agree with ourselves for many of the same reasons (nepotism, corruption)
 - Our government is split between wanting to secede from Tigray and those that want us to aspire for power within Ethiopia

We can't seem all seem to agree enough to unify coherently, due to the many agendas both personal and organizational, but we all agree on a core premise: we want Tigray to be a safe, hospitable, and evergreen place. The Tigray we grew up in, learned about, or have dreamed of.

This starts by finding common ground amongst each other.

A personal agenda be damned when it means the safety of young women.

A political agenda be damned when it means the health of the elderly who created us.

An organisational agenda be damned when it means the future of the youth can be promising and as bright as our 13 months of sunshine.

There are too many diaspora that exist today that have followed the tried and true playbook to keeping their motherland and diaspora alive and well. The Koreans, the Armenians, the Indians and whatever your personal thoughts are on Israel, the Jewish.

We should be doing more to uplift each other for the work we do is tiresome and thankless. It is without pay, but with the hope of a rebuilt Tigray.

No longer do any of us wish for Tigray to be rebuilt, we simply wish it to be built and thriving of its own accord.

That starts with recognizing what we have in common with each other and centering ourselves on the core issues:

The political stability of the land (chiefly, doing what it takes to make sure the people in the land are well)

The health and wellbeing of her people

The education and infrastructure of the land

The togetherness of the diaspora, through which we can accomplish so many things related to those core issues.

The last one, while not a core issue, is the one that I can affect the most. By highlighting those in the diaspora, individuals and/or their organizations, I hope to bring their stories and their thoughts/words to the people directly. They are the ones directly doing the tiresome work on the core issues I've highlighted. And perhaps by giving a glimpse of their work, unblemished and without agenda, we can see what makes the others like us tick and realize that we have more in common together.

Something that can help bring more voices, hands, ears and brains to the right causes that help us truly rebuild Tigray.

I came to this realisation that as myself, I don't quite have the historical knowledge, resources, relationships or any other relevant credential to desire a name or a face in this movement.

But I know that I will be the better for it with this end goal. My future children as well.

I regret and despise thinking of a future where the Tigrayan diaspora allowed itself

to squabble and bicker itself into irrelevance.

May that never happen.

So what does rebuild Tigray in this current format/website look like?

1. A website

1. A directory of organizations, where they each individually have their own profile sharing what they do, their mission/vision, any relevant people with them
2. A blog page, where I can post blogs of interviews with people at these organizations, or on their own, in their own words speaking about what they do for the diaspora
3. A gallery. Initially this will just contain pictures I've obtained. The goal of this is to showcase what the goal of the mission is: to see a better diaspora, which ultimately leads to a better Tigray
- 4.